

Bryson Loflin
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EDUCATION

Ph.D., Ecology and Evolutionary Biology, Princeton University, Princeton, NJ 2025 - Present
B.S., Department of Biology, UNC Chapel Hill, Chapel Hill, NC 2021 - 2025

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Combining field and laboratory work while using animal systems, with a focus on cooperative social behaviors, to answer questions in ecology and evolution.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Graduate Research

Dr. Gerald Carter, Associate Professor, Department of Ecology and Evolutionary Biology, Princeton

Projects:

- Reciprocity and fitness interdependence in vampire bats Summer 2025 - Present
- Bayesian social relations models of grooming and food sharing 2025 - Present
- Defection experiments to test partner choice in captive colonies 2026 - Present
- Machine learning to identify individual bats from video 2026 - Present

Undergraduate Research

Dr. Karin Pfennig, Professor, Department of Biology, UNC Chapel Hill

Projects:

- Evaluated presence and distribution of a behavioral syndrome 2022 - 2025
- Genotyped individuals to evaluate species co occurrence Spring 2021
- Evaluated adaptive hybridization through a literature review Fall 2020

Undergraduate Research

Dr. Michael Sheehan, Associate Professor, Department of Neurobiology and Behavior, Cornell

Project:

- Quantify the behavioral impacts of mouse rewilding Summer 2024

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Teaching Assistant; Life on Earth

Fall 2025

Department of Ecology and Evolutionary Biology, Princeton

Teaching Assistant; Seafood Forensics

Fall 2023 - Spring 2025

Department of Biology, UNC Chapel Hill

Teaching Assistant; Investigating the Biodiversity Crisis

Spring 2024

Department of Biology, UNC Chapel Hill

WORK EXPERIENCE

Senior Residential Computing Consultant
Carolina Housing, UNC Chapel Hill

Fall 2023 - Spring 2025

Residential Computing Consultant
ResNET, Carolina Housing, UNC Chapel Hill

Fall 2021 - Spring 2022

PUBLICATIONS

- Zipple, M. N., **Loflin, B.**, Chang Kuo, D., Tan, E., & Sheehan, M. J. (2025). Transfer to a naturalistic setting restructures fear responses in laboratory mice. *Current Biology*, 35(24), R1175-R1176. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.cub.2025.10.050>
- Ryan, S., Kelly, P., **Loflin, B.**, & Pfennig, K. S. (2025). Experimentally testing the hypothesis that hybrid fitness can increase evolutionarily: An example in spadefoot toads. *Ecology and Evolution*, 15(12), e72531. <https://doi.org/10.1002/ece3.72531>
- Ryburn, S. J., Yu, T., Ong, K. J., Wisely, E., Alston, M. A., Howie, E., LeRoy, P., Giang, S. E., Ball, W., Benton, J., Calhoun, R., Favreau, I., Gutierrez, A., Hallac, K., Hanson, D., Hibbard, T., **Loflin, B.**, Lopez, J., Mock, G., ... Bruno, J. F. (2025). Sale of critically endangered sharks in the United States. *Frontiers in Marine Science*, 12, 1604454. <https://doi.org/10.3389/fmars.2025.1604454>

TALKS AND PRESENTATIONS

- ABS Poster: *Cooperative relationship formation in vampire bats: Does helping become more symmetrical over time?* Summer 2026
- Senior Honors Thesis Presentation Spring 2025
- UNC Research and Discovery Fair Fall 2024
- ABS Co-Author: Behavior's role in the evolution of species ranges Summer 2024
- Research Symposium: *A behavioral syndrome in *Spea bombifrons** Spring 2022
- Research Symposium: *The sale of critically endangered sharks in the United States* Spring 2022

HARD SKILLS

- Bayesian social relations models and network analysis in R (STRAND, Stan, brms)
- Machine learning re-identification of individual animals from video (Python, SLEAP)
- Data analysis in R and JMP
- Captive vampire bat husbandry and fasting trials
- Scoring social behavior from infrared video (BORIS)
- RFID chipping of mice and RFID tracking of bats
- Open field and mate choice tests on spadefoot toads
- Plus maze tests, submandibular blood collection, and capture of rewilded mice
- Capture of spadefoot toads and transport of animals between lab and field sites
- Novel protocol development for behavioral assays
- DNA extraction, PCR, and preparation of samples for Sanger Sequencing
- Technology troubleshooting

SOFT SKILLS

- Communicating data
- Team management
- Time management
- Mentee training
- Academic writing

HONORS AND AWARDS

NSF Graduate Research Fellowship Program Honorable Mention	Spring 2026
- Awarded by the National Science Foundation to highly ranked applicants	
Robert Coker Award	Spring 2025
- Given to one senior biology major each year for excellence in research	
Highest Honors Senior Thesis	Spring 2025
- Awarded for meeting the most rigorous standards of scholarly excellence	
Carolina Housing Hall of Fame	Spring 2024
- Awarded to Carolina Housing staff for exceptional service	
RCC of the Semester	Spring 2022
- Awarded to one of the 40+ staff team for contributions to ResNET	
North Carolina Association of Student Councils Hall of Fame	Summer 2018
- Awarded to individuals for distinguished service towards their student council	

OUTREACH AND SERVICE

- Out in STEM (oSTEM)
- Undergraduate research mentoring
- Vampire bat cooperation game and science pages at brysonloflin.com

REFERENCES

Gerald Carter, Associate Professor

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Princeton University
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Karin Pfennig, Professor

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Michael Sheehan, Associate Professor

Department of Neurobiology and Behavior
Cornell University
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John Bruno, Chi Omega Distinguished Professor

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